

Fleet Street 1800's

No. 157

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

April 2026

The 19th century saw many important events, including the Battle of Trafalgar (1805), the Great Reform Act (1832), the opening of the first London Underground (1863), and the death of Queen Victoria (1901).

Although the Fleet River had been covered over in 1736, its history continued to shape the area. South of Fleet Street lay Alsatia, or the "Liberty of the Fleet", a district known for instant marriages.

As London's population grew, Smithfield Market expanded to supply more food. Better roads, faster stagecoaches and William Dockwra's Penny Post improved travel, communication and trade, helping newspapers reach more readers.



The London railway boom in the 1800's